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How election offices answered a rumor *in four days.*

Fifteen counties in five states posted rebuttals within four days. What they wrote, and what 524 governments posted this year to reassure voters.



SHOW THE RUMOR, THEN THE RULE

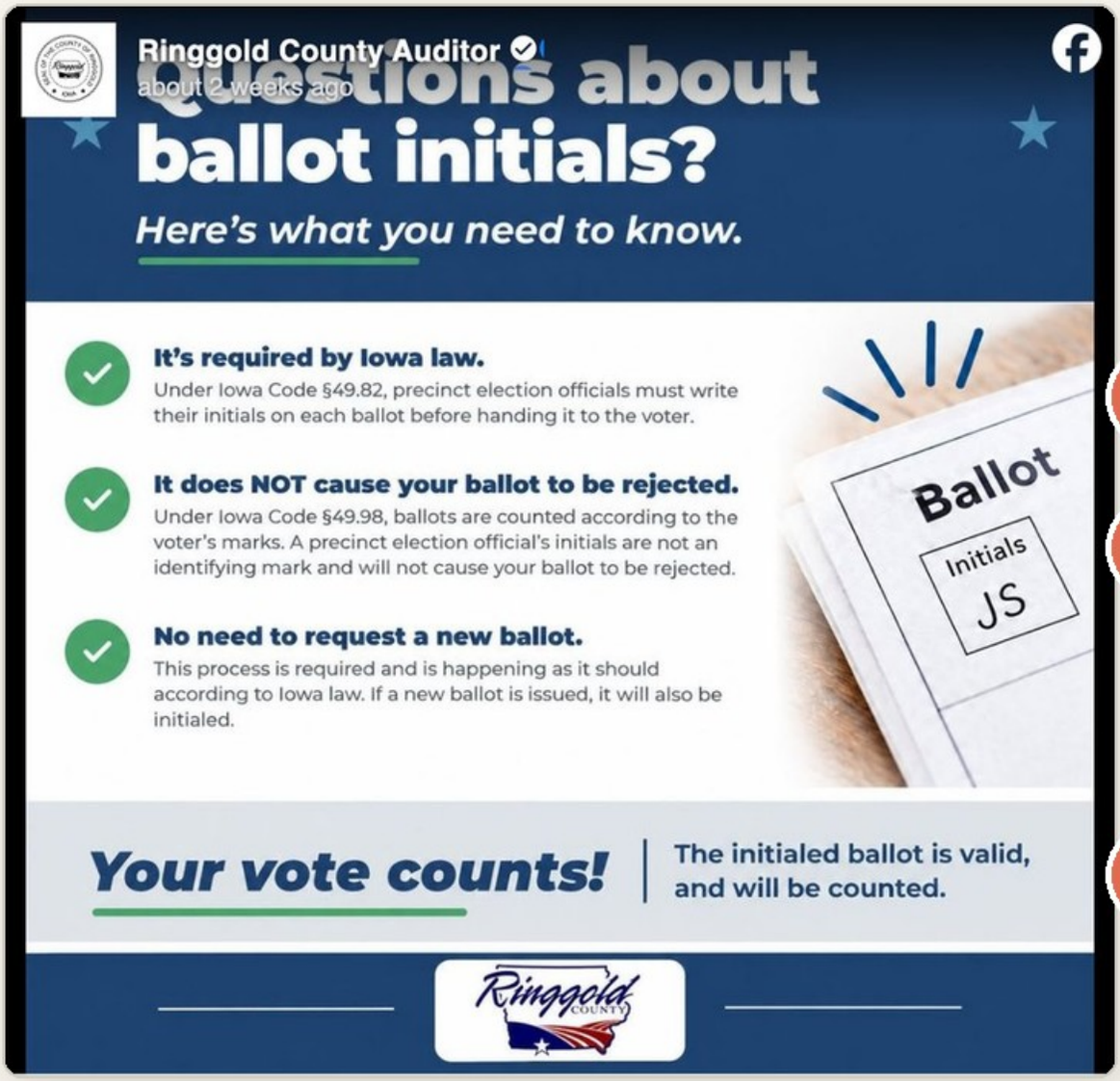
Grundy County, Illinois



1. Puts the circulating claim on screen and stamps it false.
2. Lists the facts beside it: judges must initial every ballot in red pen.
3. Closes by asking residents to get information from a trusted source.

CITE THE LAW

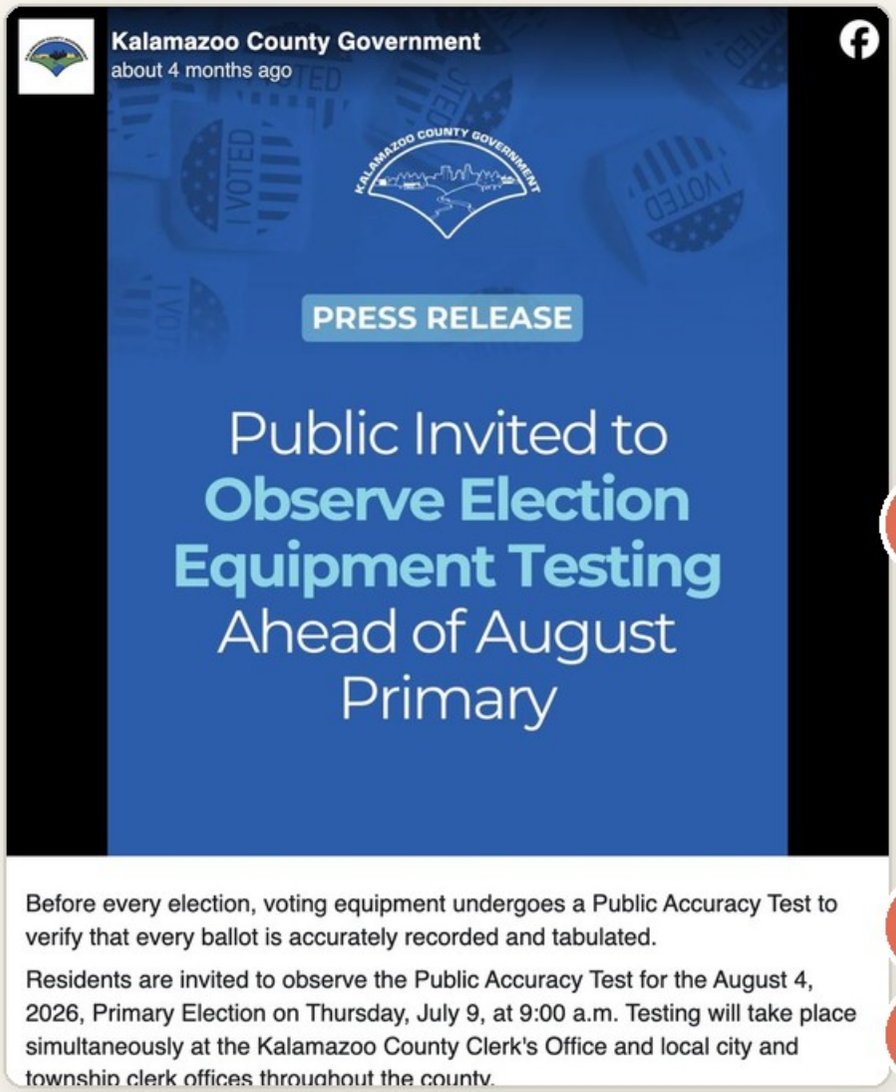
Ringgold County, Iowa



1. Names the code section that requires the initials.
2. Answers the three questions a worried voter has: required? rejected? new ballot?
3. Ends on the line residents most need: "Your vote counts!"

INVITE PEOPLE TO WATCH

Kalamazoo County, Michigan



1. Turns a press release into an invitation: observe the equipment test.
2. Explains what the Public Accuracy Test checks.
3. Gives the date, the time, and every place it happens.

FROM THE REPORT

Five ways governments reassured voters this year

1. **Show the process.**
   Equipment tests and open counts residents can watch. The most common approach.

2. **Answer the rumor with the rule.**
   Name the false claim, then cite the law that decides it.

3. **Explain mail-ballot safeguards.**
   Who can return a ballot, and how signatures are checked.

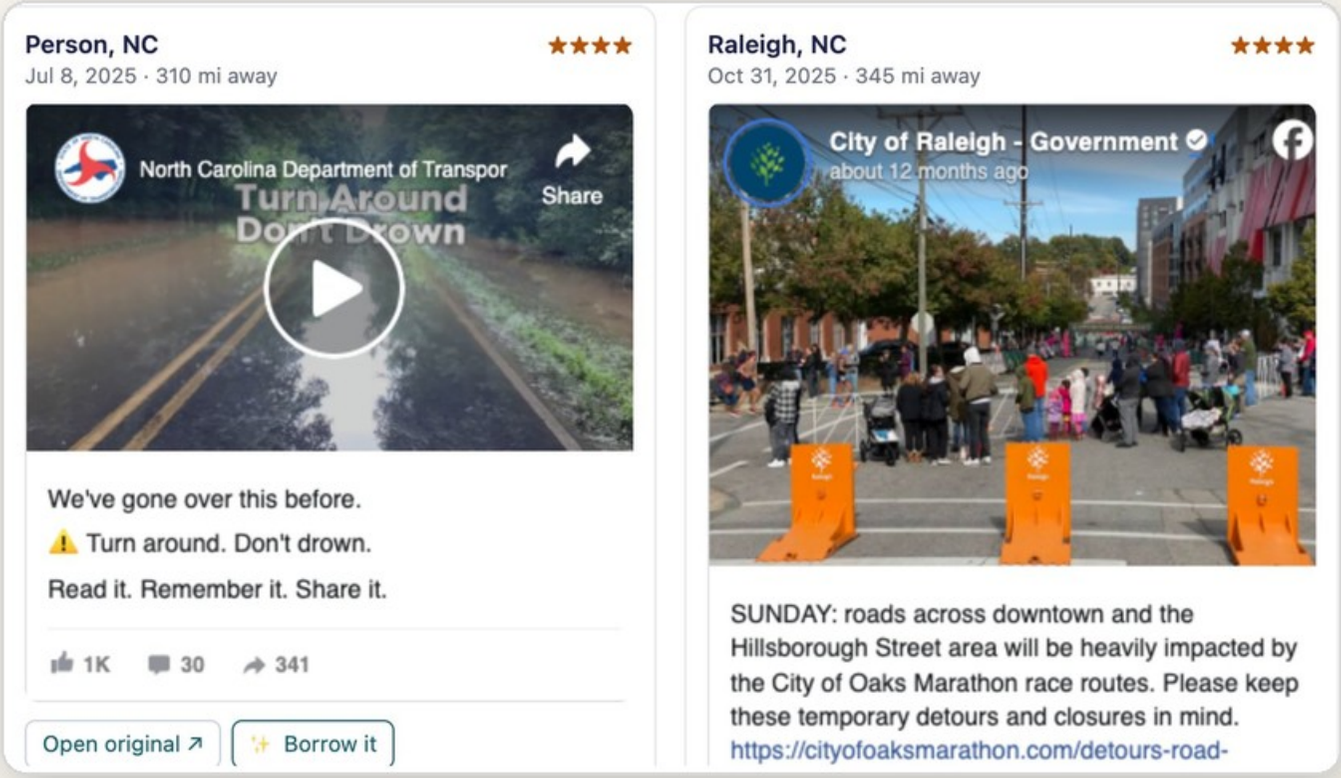
4. **Warn about scam mailers.**
   Third-party mailings that look official, and what to ignore.

5. **Run an explainer series.**
   The path of a ballot, one step at a time.

BEFORE THE NEXT ELECTION

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